

'Retribution': Trump calls for Epstein inquiry into Democrats



Ralph Alswang, Office of the President - Clinton Presidential Library

Written by [David Badash](#) | November 14, 2025 | 12:13PM ET



President Donald [Trump](#) is intensifying his efforts to thwart attempts to force the release of the Epstein files, even as the House moves toward a vote that could send disclosure legislation

On Friday, the president **announced** he will ask the U.S. Department of Justice, Attorney General Pam Bondi, and the Federal Bureau of Investigation “to investigate Jeffrey Epstein’s involvement and relationship with Bill Clinton, Larry Summers, Reid Hoffman, J.P. Morgan, Chase, and many other people and institutions, to determine what was going on with them, and him.”

The New York Times reported that the “inquiry appeared to be retribution for the renewed focus on his own ties to Mr. Epstein.”

After White House officials **reportedly** held a Situation Room meeting with Republican Congresswoman Lauren Boebert on Wednesday to convince her — unsuccessfully — to remove her name from the discharge petition, the president on Friday took a different tack, appearing both to try to wash his hands of the entire ordeal while refocusing attention on his political opponents and others.

“Epstein was a Democrat, and he is the Democrat’s problem, not the Republican’s problem!” Trump **railed** on his Truth Social website, while attacking Democrats.

“The Democrats are doing everything in their withering power to push the Epstein Hoax again, despite the DOJ releasing 50,000 pages of documents, in order to deflect from all of their bad policies and losses, especially the SHUTDOWN EMBARRASSMENT, where their party is in total disarray, and has no idea what to do,” Trump alleged.

Join Alternet All-Access. Go AD-Free. 

“Some Weak Republicans have fallen into their clutches because they are soft and foolish,” the president continued. “Epstein was a Democrat, and he is the Democrat’s problem, not the Republican’s problem!”

“Ask Bill Clinton, Reid Hoffman, and Larry Summers about Epstein, they know all about him, don’t waste your time with Trump. I have a Country to run!”

[Deadline](#) on Friday noted that “Since the email release, Trump has avoided answering reporters’ questions about Epstein.”

Pointing to Trump’s Friday remarks, Politico’s Kyle Cheney [remarked](#), “Trump again pleads with Republicans to stop talking about Epstein. The pressure hasn’t worked as well as it usually does. Also, the emails show Epstein was politically amorphous, deriding Ds just as much as Rs. And these latest emails were from the Epstein estate, not DOJ.”

Attorney Aaron Parnas [added](#), “I guarantee you if Donald Trump truly believed Epstein was the ‘Democrat’s problem,’ he would have released all of the files by now.”

There's a reason 200,000 people subscribe to AlterNet.

You can get the news before it breaks just by subscribing, plus you learn something new every day.

SUBMIT

You may opt out any time. By signing up for this newsletter, you agree to the [Terms and Conditions](#) and [Privacy Policy](#).

Report typos and corrections to: feedback@alternet.org.

*Do you feel Democrats can
regain control of Congress in
2026?*

VOTE NOW



**'He just lied':
Johnson skewered
by colleagues as
House closes —
again**

**The true risk
behind Trump's
purges**

**The fight for our
democracy won't be
won by appeasing
bullies**

MOST POPULAR

1

**'He just lied': Johnson
skewered by colleagues as
House closes — again**

2

**'They didn't need to!' George
Conway debunks MAGA's key
argument about Epstein files**

3

**Texas Republicans regret
'their overconfidence' as
Trump-led effort 'may end up
backfiring'**

4

**Right-wing media is
'coalescing' around one
desperate message to defend
Trump**

6

Americans 'horrified' as new image of Trump's White House 'wreckage' emerges

7

Busted: Firm tied to Kristi Noem secretly got money from government contracts

8

This Trump country special election could 'send shockwaves around the country'

9

Donald Trump's 'grand conspiracy' theory begins to take shape — and it might work

10

'MAGA media in shambles' as it struggles to protect Trump

Trending Topics

George Conway • Noam Chomsky • Civil War • Kayleigh Mcenany • Melania Trump • Drudge Report • Paul Krugman • Lindsey Graham • Lincoln Project • Al Franken Bill Maher • People Of Praise • Ivanka Trump • Eric Trump

colleagues as House closes — again

Texas Republicans regret 'their overconfidence' as Trump-led effort 'may end up backfiring'

Americans 'horrified' as new image of Trump's White House 'wreckage' emerges

'I want this': Democratic donor targeted by Trump calls his bluff over Epstein files

Right-wing media is 'coalescing' around one desperate message to defend Trump

'Mask comes off': Trump branded an 'elitist' as base questions 'America First' focus

Trump 'bracing for impact' as 'broad cross-section' of GOP conference plans to go against him

Reagan-appointed judge accuses Supreme Court of undermining rule of law to help Trump

Trump attacks 'ranting lunatic' Marjorie Taylor Greene — and calls for primary challenge

'Unabashed corruption': DOJ slammed for letting Trump dictate Epstein investigation

Get the latest stories. Sign up for AlterNet's free daily newsletter.

Email address

SUBMIT

You may opt out any time. By signing up for this newsletter, you agree to the [Terms and Conditions](#) and [Privacy Policy](#).

Contact

Advertise with AlterNet

Privacy Policy

Writer Guidelines

Press Information

About AlterNet

Meet the AlterNet Staff

Debug Logs

@2025 - AlterNet Media Inc. All Rights Reserved. - "Poynter" fonts provided by fontsempire.com.